

Diploma in Leadership & Management

Team tools to use for modern managers and leaders



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Lesson outcomes

The student will be able to understand the fundamentals of virtual interviews and onboarding. Students will be able to conduct their own virtual interviews. Students will also be able to understand the basics when it comes to the onboarding process

Introduction



Interviews are conducted all around the world. For so long, all interviews had to be in person

But not anymore. Today we were looking at virtual interviews and then expanding with that in mind to look at onboarding. Onboarding is the process that can change the way employees feel about the company and it creates a lasting impression of the company. “A virtual interview is an interview that takes place remotely, sometimes over the phone, but often using technology like video conferencing and other online communication platforms.” (Indeed)

Key reading materials:

- <https://www.saplinghr.com/top-employee-onboarding-programs>
 - <https://www.selectsoftwarereviews.com/buyer-guide/best-video-interview-software>
 - <https://modernhire.com/7-stats-that-will-get-you-interviewing-online/>
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Online interview Questions to ask:



According to (Inc) here are the following interview questions to think about or consider when conducting your next online interview. Please note that these are directly supplied by Inc.com

Are you good at managing yourself?

The phrase "self-starter" has been overused in employment ads, but that's what a remote employee needs to be. This question may help you find out if your candidate has this essential skill.

Are you proactive about communicating?

A successful remote employee has to be someone quick to get in touch in most situations. "This is a really important trait because I can't look and see if someone's in the office pacing in frustration," Sutton Fell says. I have to depend on employees to let me know when something's wrong--and also when good things happen.

How do you feel about our product?

Enthusiasm for the company and its products is an attractive quality in any potential hire. But it takes on greater importance in a virtual work situation. "Your job is right in front of you every single day," Sutton Fell explains. "You don't have the commute or other distractions. You have to really like it to keep at it, so we look for people who will enjoy their jobs and our mission."

What is your ideal work environment?

You're usually best off hiring a candidate who specifically wants to work remotely, rather than someone who just wants the job. "Some people are game for anything," Sutton Fell says. That might sound good, but in practice she finds the best people for remote positions are those who have a real interest in working remotely. "Most of our hires really value working from home."

Do you have a quiet space where you can work uninterrupted?

A job candidate is unlikely to succeed if he or she is trying to work at the dining room table while children or other family members wander in and out.

How's your relationship with your computer?

Keep in mind that someone working remotely won't have access to your company's tech support person or team. That means winning candidates should have their own tech support system in place. In general, Sutton Fell adds, you want people who are at ease with their computers and any other technology they'll need on the job, since they'll mostly have to trouble-shoot any issues for themselves.

How much of your social life comes from work?

"You won't have that forced interaction, someone popping into your office and saying 'I like your skirt,'" Sutton Fell notes. "I've had people tell me that they don't like working from home because they have no one to talk with all day. Having other things going on in their lives can be very helpful."

Are you a people pleaser?

This might seem like a loaded question in a job interview. But Sutton Fell says it's worth making sure that remote employees will tell you what they're really thinking and not what you want to hear. "In a virtual environment, it can be harder to tell when someone is doing that," she explains. "Another way to ask is, 'Are you comfortable bringing up conflict?'"

She says that most successful candidates will answer something like this: "I'm a people pleaser to some degree, so if I need to say something negative I'll look for a nice way to say it. I don't look for conflict but if something needs to be addressed, I feel comfortable addressing it."

Are you an optimist?

Successful remote-work candidates are "friendly and generally optimistic," Sutton Fell says. "Working virtually you have different challenges." Someone who's friendly and generally upbeat will both be in a better position to meet those challenges and also will more easily form relationships with remote colleagues.

Please describe yourself in five words.

Sutton Fell admits that she sometimes feels a little silly asking for this. She does it anyway because it can tell her quite a lot about a job candidate. "I intentionally do it off the cuff," she says. "I want to know what people think is important about themselves."

Virtual interview questions and strategies when preparing to be interviewed:



As stated by (bestjobinterview)

Tell me a little about yourself

This question sets the stage for your online interview. The key things to remember are to be concise and target your answer to the job opportunity. A full discussion of how to best answer this question can be found at [Tell Me About Yourself](#)

Why do you want this job?

This is where your homework comes into play. Know as much as possible about the job and the company before you sit down for your interview.

Focus on what you can do for the company rather than what the employer can do for you. Practice this interview answer beforehand so you can answer with confidence and clarity.

Why do you think you are the right candidate for this job?

Discuss your related skills and experience. Highlight your on-point competencies. Discuss your all-round fit with the job and company. Find your unique selling point, something that can differentiate you from the competition.

What is your biggest accomplishment to date?

Your life is full of achievements. Focus on a relevant work-related achievement to discuss. If you have little work experience consider a personal goal you achieved. Interview Answer

What motivates you?

Motivation is crucial in every job. Expect online interview questions that explore your motivation. The passion and energy you convey in answering this question will add credibility to your answer.

Why do you want to leave your job?

There are some key pitfalls to avoid when answering this online interview question.

Avoid saying anything negative about your previous employer, focus on the future not the past and ensure that the things you say you are looking for in a job can be met by the position and company you are interviewing with.

Where else have you applied?

Interviewers ask this to determine how interested you really are in their job opportunity. They want to know if the types of jobs you have applied for are in line with this position.

Do you have any questions?

It is critical to have a couple of insightful questions ready to ask. Prepare these ahead of time. Avoid asking anything that has already been answered during your interview or something you could easily have picked up from the job posting.

Top tips for conducting a great virtual interview:



According to (Anderson, n.d.) we see the following insights and direct quotes. For some recruiters, video interviews are familiar and their companies have established videoconferencing capabilities. For so many others, this is new and their companies are quickly adapting to new technologies and adjusting traditional ways of doing work. Whether you're a video-interviewing veteran or a virtual novice, consider the tips below. The good news is that many of the same approaches and considerations that you bring to in-person candidate interviews will serve you well while conducting video interviews.

Set a process for how interviews will be run and communicate clearly and thoroughly with your teammates and candidates

As your policies and procedures change in the face of coronavirus, make sure you and your talent acquisition teammates are all on the same page about how you're going to conduct interviews moving forward.

If all your job interviews are going to be done by videoconferencing, you should quickly let all candidates know that. Underscore that this is being done to protect their health (and yours).

“One of the most sizable challenges when going remote,” says Darren Murph, head of remote at GitLab, which is 100% remote, “is keeping everyone in the loop in an efficient way. Put concerted effort around systematically documenting important process changes in a central place to minimize confusion and dysfunction.”

Put your candidates at ease by sharing expectations, timelines, names of interviewers

During times of high stress and uncertainty, don't hesitate to overcommunicate. Once your candidates know that their interviews will be done via videoconference — and why — reach out to them and give them a rundown on the details of their interviews, just as you would if they were coming in to talk to people onsite.

Here are some useful things to share:

- Tips on how to access the videoconferencing technology and whether they need to download any software.
- Your team's expectations for their interviews. For example, will the interviewer request a work sample or ask them to solve a problem on the spot?
- A timeline that details when their interviews will start and end and the names and titles of each person they will meet, along with links to their LinkedIn profiles.
- Practice a compelling (virtual-only) company culture pitch
- One of the challenges with video interviews is that your candidates are not going to have a chance to walk around your office space and campus and get a firsthand glimpse of your company culture. To compensate for that, spend extra time preparing a compelling culture pitch. Our head of recruiting, Brendan Browne, says, “There's a humongous opportunity to differentiate yourself as a recruiter by telling a compelling story,” focusing on your company's mission and vision and how that ties to the candidate's values.
- To get a little extra support in painting your company's culture, consider if there are any visual materials you can share with candidates during or after the interview. The chances are you have a library of employee testimonials or social media posts capturing meaningful moments in the day-to-day work life of your employees.

Practice a compelling (virtual-only) company culture pitch

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Top tips and tricks of successful onboarding



According to (Ulrich, n.d.) we see the following tips and tricks that he deems the most valuable for managers and leaders to note.

Check list items:

- Help the employee understand the company culture
- Help the employee reach small wins in the beginning to help boost confidence
- Assign a mentor to help the employee
- Start with the continuous learning process ASAP

Talent acquisition:

As directly stated by (Pir) talent acquisition is the most strategic people process for an organization and a thoughtful process calls for careful job analysis, strategic sourcing, thorough examination and cultural on-boarding. That last step is equally important!

Years of research shows us that effective on-boarding can make or break a new hire – meaning it can help a new hire get acclimated into an organization and break motivation in the initial 90 days.

On-boarding in 21st century requires immediate managers and teams to show care for their new team members not only professionally, but personally as well.

There is a list of formal and informal procedures, norms, behaviors a new hire needs to learn in a new job and inside of a new culture.

During this transition period, managers can provide support by purposefully introducing new hires into the workplace culture, by offering timely and constructive feedback, by providing context for the WHY of things as well as by educating on the HOW.

They can also provide emotional support by checking in on their internal change process by asking how they are feeling with regards to new workplace and organizational culture.

In return, new hires can seek support by purposefully connecting with key stakeholders, asking clarifying questions, connecting with team members to build trust and rapport and by inquiring for an internal mentor.

On a tactical level, a detailed orientation plan always helps both parties focus objectives and keep track.

Start prior to the arrival date:

Make sure that you have sent out key information about the firm and operations before the employee starts. You can send out key reading materials, log in details and content that the employee can work on their own time.

Help the employee feel like they are part of the team:

Make sure that you have a strategy in place to help the employee feel like they are welcome and part of the team. Change is tough and helping the transition go smoothly is the role of the manager and leader when you introduce someone new to the team.

Onboarding and retention goes hand-in-hand

As directly stated by (Malhotra), we see the following insights:

It is important to take into consideration the specific industry, role, and the definition of the 'ideal employee' for the organisation.

Training should cover programs, best practices, technology, and equipment and have goals clearly stated; onboarding doesn't stop at company policies, facility tours, and department introductions.

Each year, technology advances and a new generation of applicants are joining the workforce. With it, the methods of attracting, guiding and retaining workers are transforming. My top rules are:

- Onboarding Is not the same as training
- Structured onboarding impacts retention
- Training must encompass the "how" and the "why"

If you look closely at the studies, you'll see that staff onboarding and retention go hand-in-hand:

1. 69% of employees are more likely to stay with a company for three years if they experienced great on boarding
 2. Up to 20% of employee turnover happens in the first 45 days
 3. New employees who went through a structured onboarding program were 58% more likely to be with the organization after three years
 4. Organizations with a standard on boarding process experience 50% greater new hire retention
 5. Nearly 33% of new hires look for a new job within their first six months on the job
 6. 60% of companies fail to set milestones or goals for new hires
 7. It typically takes eight months for a newly hired employee to reach full productivity
 8. 22% of companies have no formal on boarding program
 9. Manager satisfaction increases by 20% when their employees have formal on boarding training
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HR, hiring and Onboarding stats to know:



According to (Turczynski, n.d.) here are the following HR stats to know. We will look at onboarding, hiring and turnover statistics.

- 90% of job seekers say that it's important to work for a company that embraces transparency.
(Glassdoor U.S. Site Survey)
- 79% of job seekers say they are likely to use social media in their job search
(Glassdoor)
- On average, each corporate job offer attracts 250 resumes. Of those candidates, 4 to 6 will get called for an interview, and only one will get the job.
(Glassdoor) 1 in 6 candidates who applied for a job were asked for an interview.
- Recruiters take an average of 6 seconds to scan a resume.
(TheLadders)
- 87% of recruiters use LinkedIn to check candidates.
(Jobvite Recruiter Nation Report)
- After finding a job offer, 64% of candidates said they research a company online and 37% said they will move on to another job offer if they can't find information on the company.
(Careerbuilder)
- Top 5 pieces of information job seekers want employers to provide as they research where to work:
 - Details on compensation packages
 - Details on benefits packages
 - Basic company information
 - Details on what makes the company an attractive place to work
 - Company mission, vision and values (Glassdoor U.S. Site Survey)
- 91% of employers prefer their candidates to have work experience, and 65% of them prefer their candidates to have relevant work experience.
(NACE Job Outlook)

- 87% of Millennials rate professional career growth and developmental opportunities as important to them in a job.
(Gallup)
- Nearly 80% of Millennials look for people and culture fit with employers, followed by career potential.
(Collegefeed)

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